

ASSIGNMENT #I

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WHAT DO I KNOW ABOUT PAKISTAN?

Geography:

Pakistan is a country situated in South West Asia. It borders 4 countries in total, China in the North (Khunjerab Pass), Afghanistan and Iran in the West (Durand Line and Taftan Border) and India in the East (Wagah Border). Pakistan is divided into 6 major provinces namely, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KPK), Punjab, Sindh, Balochistan, Gilgit Baltistan and Azad Kashmir. The capital city of Pakistan as of now is Islamabad but since the creation of Pakistan (1947) up until 1958 Karachi was recognized as the capital city. Pakistan has a very vast topography with mountains and plateaus in the North, Coastal areas in Karachi, Plains in the Punjab and deserts in Sindh and Balochistan.

Weather:

Due to its varying topography Pakistan experiences a diverse range of weather conditions and seasons throughout the year. Winter usually lasts 3 months starting in December and ending in February. Summer occupies most of the year starting in as soon as April and going till September with short spells of Autumn and Spring (usually last a month or 2). This is general overview of the weather however, different areas experience different seasons differently as the Summers are quite lenient in the north with pleasant temperatures while very harsh in the coastal areas where temperature rise to unbearable levels with a lot of humidity in the air and the plains where temperatures may rise to as high as 50°C. Pakistan receives rainfall through 2 major sources, Monsoon and Western Depression. Monsoon is typically common around November to February in Punjab while the Western Depression mainly provides rainfall to the west of the country (KPK). It is also common to have snowfall in the northern parts a handful of times throughout the year.

History:

Pakistan obtained the status of independence on the 14th of August 1947 under the leadership of Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Quaid is credited to be the 'Father of Pakistan'. Another significant figures who contributed towards the creation of Pakistan is Allama Muhammad Iqbal who is widely considered one of the most influential poets and philosophers of the 20th century. Allama was the one who envisioned a separate land for the Muslims of the Sub-Continent where they would be free and their rights would be recognized. The name Pakistan was coined by Chaudry Rahmat Ali a famous participant of the Pakistan Movement. The Two Nation Theory devised by Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, is widely known to be the baseline which lead to the division of the Sub-Continent. It said that the Muslims and Hindus of the Sub-Continents are two distinct nations. Overall the history of Pakistan is one filled with struggle, failures and success.

Industry:

The main Industrial sector upholding the economy of Pakistan is Agriculture. Pakistan mainly exports agricultural products and crops such as rice and fruits and is one of the top exporters of rice on the planet. Besides agriculture the textiles and apparel industry is also one to take note of. The main products that are exported in this industry are cotton yarn, fabric and ready-made garments. Sialkot in Punjab is known for producing high quality sports goods and equipment, most notable of these is the production of footballs for the FIFA world cup. The Tech Industry of Pakistan is also developing at a rapid pace with much of the population taking interest in Computer Science. Recently Pakistan has witnessed the opening of many local tech businesses such as software houses and IT companies, many people have also started offering their services online and earning money through freelancing. There has been massive amounts of growth in the Tourism industry and many foreigners are now coming to Pakistan to explore and experience the beauty of it's Northern Areas.

Culture:

Pakistan has one of the biggest populations in the world (230M) and with that comes a large diversity of people. A large number of Pashtuns are inhabitant in KPK while the Punjabis are the common folk of Punjab. The people of Sindh are called Sindhis while the ones who belong to Balochistan are called Balochis. This high variety of people establishes a cultural difference between the provinces of Pakistan. The most common apparel for men in Pakistan is Shalwar Qameez while the women wear the same but with the addition of a scarf. Some people of Balochistan, KPK, Sindh and Gilgit live a nomadic lifestyle to live in favorable conditions throughout the year.

